



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

You never know who you're going to bump into!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about socializing.
- I can express possibility or certainty.
- I can talk about life experiences.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have a favorite place in your neighborhood? What is it?
- Where do you go if you want to meet your old friends? Why?





Let's Explore!

Peter catches up with an old friend. **The vibe*** in this bar is really nice!

* "The vibe" means the atmosphere, the mood of a place.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Hey Matt, long time no see!
- Matt:** How's it going Peter? I didn't know you liked this bar, too.
- Peter:** I started coming here after work a couple of weeks ago. I had read about it in the paper last month before it opened. I really like the vibe here. What are you up to, anyway?
- Matt:** I'm waiting for someone ...
- Peter:** Oh, like a date or something? It sounds like I may be interrupting.
- Matt:** I'm meeting an old girlfriend, Cathy. We bumped into each other last week at the gym.
- Peter:** That explains why you look so buff now! You must have put on a few pounds of muscle since the last time I saw you!
- Matt:** I could have. I had bought a gym subscription before my work schedule changed. I thought it would be a good way to keep fit and meet new people.
- Peter:** That's a good idea. I certainly could use lifting some dumbbells right now. I had become quite athletic after all those soccer games, but I couldn't keep up with the practice sessions on top of my heavy workload.
- Matt:** We miss you, man. I'm sure you must miss the locker-room conversations, too.
- Peter:** Yeah ... I had grown fond of those. I was sad to give that up. I may come with you to the gym some time. Who knows, I might be lucky too!
- Matt:** You never know. That's how I met Cathy! I had just filled up my bottle at the water cooler when I saw her right in front of me!





Let's Practice!

Mark and Matt are talking about their social life at the pub*.

* a bar or a tavern.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. How's it going Mark? I didn't know you liked this bar too.
2. I'm meeting an old girlfriend, Cathy. We bumped into each other last week at the gym.
3. Really? I'm meeting some friends from college, imagine!
4. I thought it would be a good way to keep fit and meet new people.
5. I'm sure you must miss the locker-room conversations.



Let's Practice!

Matt and Peter are talking about their past experiences with sports.

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. I _____ a gym subscription before my work schedule_____.
2. I _____ quite athletic after all those soccer games.
3. I _____ to start training, but then I _____ because I had no time.
4. I never _____ going to the gym, I _____ it was so boring!

Word bank

- thought
- think
- liked
- stopped
- stop
- decided
- like
- buy
- had become
- changed
- had bought





Extension Activity

Interview your partners.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find 4 or 5 partners. Prepare 2 questions for each partner.
- Ask each partner about a hobby or a pastime that they have given up.
- Remember to use the right tenses in the past to answer the questions.
- React to the partners' questions using modals for certainty or possibility.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about social activities and pastimes.

☐ ☐

I discuss past experiences.

☐ ☐

I express possibility and certainty.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **buff** (adjective): used to describe a person who exercises a lot
e.g. That explains why you look so buff now! You must have put on a few pounds of muscle since the last time I saw you!
- **muscle** (noun): a part of the body that contracts to produce movement
e.g. You must have put on a few pounds of muscle since the last time I saw you!
- **to lift** (verb): to raise or direct upward
e.g. I must go back to the gym and start lifting weights again.
- **dumbbell** (noun): an object with two metal balls connected by a bar used as a weight for exercising
e.g. I certainly could use lifting some dumbbells right now.
- **athletic** (adjective): physically active and strong
e.g. I had become quite athletic after all those soccer games.
- **locker-room** (noun): a room containing lockers, as in a gym
e.g. I'm sure you must miss the locker-room conversations.
- **water cooler** (noun): a drinking fountain in which water is cooled by refrigeration
e.g. I had just filled up my bottle at the water cooler when I saw her right in front of me!





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

You must have put on a few pounds of muscle since the last time I saw you!

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
<i>You must have put on a few pounds of muscle since the last time I saw you!</i>	It's very likely you put on a few pounds.
<i>I couldn't keep up with the practice sessions on top of my heavy workload.</i>	It wasn't possible to keep up.
<i>It sounds like I may be interrupting.</i>	It's possible that I'm interrupting.





Learning Points

Talking About Life Experiences

You use the Past Perfect tense to ...

- Identify and talk about an 'earlier past'. When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:
Subject + had + past participle

*I **had read** about the restaurant in the paper last month before it opened.*

Which event happened *first*? I read about the restaurant in the paper.

Which event happened *later*? The restaurant opened.

- You can also use the Past Perfect tense when you want to talk about how long something had continued up to a past moment.

Example:

*I **had grown** fond of those.*

You use the Simple Past tense to ...

- Talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.
- Talk about the action that happened after that prior action in the Past Perfect tense.

Example:

*After I **had finished** working out, I **bumped into** an old friend.*

Examples:

- *I started coming here after work a couple of weeks ago.*
- *I had read about it in the paper last month before it opened.*
- *I had become quite athletic after all those soccer games, but I couldn't keep up with the practice sessions on top of my heavy workload.*

